



- Often, **quotations** are used without introductions, so no comma is needed. For example: **The guide says that this is “the best garden in France.”**
- Don’t use a comma if the first part of the quotation ends with an **exclamation point** or a **question mark**. For example: “Stop!” Tom cried. “The bridge is dangerous.”

GLOSSARY

- Adverb** A word that describes the way something happens.
- Clause** A grammatical unit that contains a subject and a verb.
- Conjunction** A word used to connect phrases and sentences.
- Direct speech** Text that represents spoken words.
- Interjection** A word or phrase that occurs alone and expresses emotion.
- Phrase** A group of words that does not contain a verb.

Direct speech

In direct speech, a comma should be used between the introduction to the speech and the direct speech itself. The introduction can be at the start, end, or middle of the sentence. When in the middle, use a comma on either side of the introduction, between the first and second parts of the sentence.

A comma is placed before the quotation mark, after the introduction.

Grandma asked, “Can we find more of these flowers?”



A comma is placed before the quotation mark, before an introduction.

“The flowers,” Lisa said, “are always in bloom in May.”

A comma is placed before the quotation mark after the introduction.



Direct address

Commas are always used when someone is spoken to directly, by name. The placement of the comma depends on where the name appears in a sentence. The commas work in the same way as around an interruption: commas to either side of the name when it appears in the middle of a sentence, a comma after the name when it starts a sentence, and a comma before the name when it comes at the end of a sentence.



- If an **interruption** is taken out of a sentence, the sentence should still make sense.
- Commas with **interjections** such as *stop* or *help* work in the same way as those for direct address.

Let’s eat Grandma.

In this example, the comma is missing, so Grandma is about to be eaten.



Let’s eat, Grandma.

A comma is placed before the name when it appears at the end of a sentence.

